

The Sādhana of Vajrayoginī the Wisdom-Holder

Vidyādhariṇī Vajrayoginī Sādhana Nāma · Toh 380 · Derge Kangyur

བདེ་མཁའ་ཉི་མེད་ཡེ་ཤེས་ཀྱི་བཟུངས་པའི་སྒྲུབ་ཀྱི་མཁའ་ཁྲུག་

Toh 380 in the Kangyur is a sādhana known in Sanskrit as the Vidyādhariṇī Vajrayoginī Sādhana Nāma and in Tibetan as the Sādhana of Vajrayoginī the Wisdom-Holder. It is a ritual and contemplative practice text belonging to the Vajrayāna tradition, presenting a structured method of visualization and meditation focused on Vajrayoginī, a prominent female tantric deity associated with wisdom and liberation. The text draws on the Great Net of Illusion tantra, grounding its instructions in the non-dual, dream-like nature of appearances arising from the heart center, and guides the practitioner through the generation of the deity from a seed syllable. It was translated into Tibetan from Sanskrit by the translator Gyi Jodawa Dawé Özer working from the oral teaching of the paṇḍita Gayadhara, and sits among the tantric sādhana literature of the Kangyur.

This completes the second chapter, which sets forth the successive teachings. This was translated from the speech of the paṇḍita Gayadhara by the translator Gyi Jodawa Dawé Özer.

In the language of India: Vidyādhariṇī Vajrayoginī Sādhana Nāma. In the language of Tibet: The Sādhana of Vajrayoginī the Wisdom-Holder (sādhana).

Now it shall be properly explained. From the Great Net of Illusion tantra of three hundred thousand verses — from the tantra known as the Great Illusion with Disheveled Hair Raised Upward — the Great Illusion is this: by emanating from the heart center, body and supreme enjoyments arise as dream-like, inseparable in non-dual bliss. Here, upon that foundation, one visualizes the seed syllable of the androgynous one. From the complete transformation of that seed syllable arises one who is red, facing upward with gaze directed above, whose left foot clasps a garland of skulls and a garland of flowers — she holds a flower noose in her left hand. She who touches the heel of her right foot holds a vajra in her right hand; she has abandoned all ornaments. She possesses the mantra practice of the vidyādhāriṇī (the wisdom-holder), she has a body that expands and gathers, and one should meditate on oneself as entering into a jeweled mansion that has arisen with the blossoming of māndāra flowers, aśoka trees, and parijāta flowers.

Oṃ bhaṃ — she is Vajravārāhī. Haṃ yoṃ — the blue one, Yamadūtī. Hrīṃ moṃ — she who causes bewilderment. Hreṃ hrīṃ — she who moves

everywhere. Hūṃ hūṃ — she who terrifies all. Phaṭ phaṭ — Caṇḍālī, marked with signs on all her limbs. The navel, the heart center, likewise the mouth, the head, and the crown — these are what is to be indicated. These five yoginīs are taught as Vajrasattva. One dons the armor of the vajra ḍākinī and offers the torma (ritual cake) that arises by its inherent nature.

Oṃ śrī heruka mahāvajra ākarṣaya ākarṣaya, praveśaya praveśaya, toṣaya toṣaya, sarva ḍākinīnām hṛdayaṃ hūṃ phaṭ. Oṃ sarva buddha ḍākinī pratīccha māṃ baliṃ hūṃ oṃ. Oṃ vajra ḍākinī pratīccha māṃ baliṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Oṃ ratna ḍākinī pratīccha māṃ baliṃ hūṃ trāṃ. Oṃ padma ḍākinī pratīccha māṃ baliṃ hūṃ hrīḥ. Oṃ viśva ḍākinī pratīccha māṃ baliṃ hūṃ āḥ. Oṃ sarva yoginī pratīccha māṃ baliṃ hūṃ hūṃ. Ha ha hi hi vajra jaḥ hūṃ baṃ hoḥ. Oṃ vajrayoginī samayaśtvaṃ dṛśya rakṣa rakṣa hoḥ.

The Sādhana of Vajrayoginī the Vidyādhārīṇī is complete.

This was translated by the great learned paṇḍita of India, the venerable Jayasena, together with the Tibetan translator, the monk Dharmayonten.

Translator's Notes

- The term rendered "androgynous one" translates ma ning, a Tibetan term for a person who is neither fully male nor female, used in tantric contexts to refer to a class of beings associated with specific seed syllables. The doctrinal identification here is with a class of beings whose seed syllable generates the visualization.

The text identifies the five yoginīs collectively as Vajrasattva, which reflects the Yoginī tantra doctrinal structure in which the assembly of ḍākinīs is understood as the embodiment of Vajrasattva's enlightened mind.

The passage "one dons the armor of the vajra ḍākinī" refers to a standard tantric armor meditation in which the practitioner visualizes protective deities at the limbs, a practice preceding the torma offering.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.